🧁 Quick Breads: Reading

Culinary 1 · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Quick Breads (plus the Quick Breads vs. Yeast Breads PowerPoint and note sheet)

Name: _____

Quick Breads

A quick bread rises fast with baking soda or baking powder instead of yeast. Muffins, biscuits, scones, pancakes, waffles and banana bread are quick breads. Yeast breads, like pizza dough and dinner rolls, need time to rise.

Baking soda needs an acid, like buttermilk or lemon juice, to make bubbles. Baking powder already has an acid inside. Most baking powder is double acting: it makes bubbles once when it gets wet and again when it gets hot in the oven.

A batter is wet; you can pour it or drop it from a spoon. A dough is thick; you can touch it and shape it. Gluten is the protein in flour. Too much mixing builds gluten and makes quick breads tough, with tunnels inside.

The muffin method: 1) mix the dry ingredients, 2) mix the wet ingredients, 3) add the wet to the dry, 4) stir just until moist. The batter should still be lumpy.

The biscuit method: mix the dry ingredients, then cut in cold fat until it looks like peas, add the liquid, and knead lightly a few times. Cold fat melts in the oven and makes flaky layers.

Check your reading

1. How is a quick bread different from a yeast bread?

2. Why should muffin batter stay lumpy?

3. What does “cut in” mean?